



For Staff

Online Influence and the Manosphere

Recognising and responding when misogynistic and harmful online content reaches students

Content Warning This guide includes misogynistic language and online harm.

This is reference guidance, not a training course. Use it to check how to respond, or to prepare for a conversation. It does not replace the school's safeguarding training, policy or the DSL's advice on a specific case.

It contains examples of misogynistic language and online content, and references to sexual harassment, image-based abuse and self-harm. Some of it may be difficult to read, particularly if it connects with your own experience or that of someone close to you.

- You can read them in sections, take a break, or step away at any point.
- If this raises something personal, you can speak in confidence to your line manager, a senior colleague you trust, or the school's Employee Assistance Programme, if it has one, or **Education Support** (free, confidential, 24/7 on 08000 562 561).
- If you have a question about how this guidance applies to a situation you are dealing with, speak to your school's Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL).

If reading this makes you worried about a child now, do not wait until you have finished reading: speak to the DSL or a deputy straight away. If a child is in immediate danger, call 999.

Immediate danger or possible risk to life: call 999 when it is needed, stay with the child, and summon the DSL or a deputy. Don't delay action to work through the steps. The 90-second Pause is for once immediate safety is secured, to stop an impulsive or investigative response.

Companion to Scenario 101

Scenario 102 is the companion to **Staff Guide 101: Misogyny and Violence Against Women and Girls**, which covers the full RESPOND response, the interactive RESPOND Helix, contacts and the Quick Reference Card. Use this guide when misogyny reaches students through online content: short videos, memes, gaming and fitness content, and the wider "manosphere".

The same principle runs through both: **recognise the pattern without labelling the child**. Most boys and young men are respectful, and some of the boys drawn to this content are harmed by it themselves.

What It Is and Why It Matters

Much of the misogyny students repeat now reaches them through short videos, memes, gaming and fitness content rather than forums they go looking for. This guide helps staff recognise that content, talk about it without closing the conversation, and judge when it becomes a safeguarding concern.

Track the Message, Not the Name

This page names no influencers or creators, in line with the RSHE statutory guidance, which advises against signposting content producers. Names change quickly: the next influential account may be one you have never heard of. Look for the **message** and the **pattern**. The key principle throughout: **recognise the pattern without labelling the child**.

- **A loose ecosystem:** many communities and creators, not one belief system. They overlap, disagree and change.
- **Shared language:** red pill, alpha and sigma hierarchies, rigid gender roles, resentment, and relationships framed as a contest between men and women.
- **A spectrum, not a label:** not all masculinity, fitness, men's mental health or family-values content is harmful. What matters is the message, the pattern, the context and the impact.
- **From forums to feeds:** young people once had to find a forum and learn its language. Now a single clip, meme or gaming edit can carry one idea without naming the ideology, and recommendation systems can bring it to them through ordinary interests such as sport, gaming and the gym.
- **A broader ecosystem:** alongside status and dating content sit looksmaxxing, rigid food and body rules, supplements and hormone anxiety, and "family values" or tradwife content presented as the only legitimate model.

Why It Can Be Compelling

Understanding the pull is part of **Pause**: it helps you respond to the need underneath rather than argue with the content.

Belonging

A community, a vocabulary and an identity, especially for a young person who feels rejected or unsure

Certainty

Simple rules for complicated questions about gender, relationships, status and success

Aspiration

Money, physique, confidence and success packaged as easy to achieve

Emotion

Anger, humour, shame and grievance are memorable and spread fast

Authenticity

Creators present themselves as outsiders "saying what others won't"

Earnings

Attention turns into subscriptions, courses, products and affiliate sales

Humour Matters: "I Know It's Bad, but It's Funny"

- **Humour lowers the temperature:** a statement framed as a joke feels less serious, so it is easier to repeat.
- **Peer currency:** memes, catchphrases and ironic references buy status and belonging.
- **Normalisation:** repetition shifts what sounds ordinary, even when a student says they don't "believe" it.
- Students can **reject the influencer and still repeat the ideas**. The RSHE statutory guidance asks staff to be conscious of everyday sexism and misogyny, and to challenge misogynistic ideas rather than the person expressing them (paragraph 80). Where comments amount to sexual harassment, KCSIE 2026 is clear that they must never be dismissed as "banter" or "just having a laugh".

How Quickly It Arrives: the Evidence

Researchers at Dublin City University set up ten new accounts on blank smartphones, five on TikTok and five on YouTube Shorts, posing as 16 and 18 year old boys. Some searched for ordinary interests (gym, sport, gaming); some searched for manosphere content; one per platform was a blank control. They then watched what the platforms recommended (April 2024).

23 min

All ten accounts were recommended toxic content within the first 23 minutes

DCU Anti-Bullying Centre, 2024

26 min

All ten were recommended manosphere content within the first 26 minutes

DCU Anti-Bullying Centre, 2024

2 to 17 min

Accounts interested only in gym, sport and gaming were recommended manosphere content after between 2 and 17 minutes, depending on platform and account

DCU Anti-Bullying Centre, 2024

76% / 78%

of recommendations in the final round (after about 400 videos, two to three hours) were problematic or toxic on TikTok / YouTube Shorts

DCU Anti-Bullying Centre, 2024

Reading This Honestly

This is a small experimental study of ten accounts from 2024, and platforms have changed their systems since. It shows **how recommendation can work**; it does not measure what every student sees. Use it to explain why a student with ordinary interests may meet this content without looking for it, not as a prevalence figure.

The researchers also **engaged with what they were shown**: they watched the recommended videos, and some accounts searched for manosphere content. The later figures (76% and 78%) reflect those experimental conditions, not an untouched feed that nobody interacts with. The early figures still show how quickly this content can appear.

Humour and peer groups: a small UK focus-group study with twelve Year 9 boys aged 13 to 14 found boys described this content as entertaining through its "shock value", and that humour let them repeat ideas while saying the creator was "putting on an act". It is a small qualitative study, useful for understanding how boys talk about the content, not for measuring how common those views are. Haslop, Ringrose, Cambazoglu and Milne (2024), *Social Media + Society* (University of Liverpool and UCL).

Decode the Feed: Terms Staff May Hear

Terms overlap and change quickly. Check this list each time you use it.

Glossary (15 terms)

Term	What it usually means
Manosphere	A loose network of online communities and creators focused on masculinity, dating, status and perceived male disadvantage. Some strands are strongly anti-feminist; they do not all hold the same beliefs.
Manfluencer	A male influencer whose content centres on masculinity, status, money, relationships or self-improvement.
Red pill	Borrowed from <i>The Matrix</i> : supposedly "waking up" to hidden truths about gender, feminism and relationships.
Black pill	A fatalistic belief, common in some incel spaces, that looks and genetics decide romantic success and nothing can change it.
Incel	"Involuntary celibate": an online identity built around not having the relationships someone wants, often with resentment towards women.
MGTOW	"Men Going Their Own Way": communities that advocate men withdrawing from relationships with women.
MRA	Men's Rights Activist. Online strands vary widely in tone and ideology.
PUA	Pick-Up Artist: a dating subculture teaching "techniques" and scripts to get attention from women.
Alpha / Beta / Sigma	Status labels used to rank boys and men. "Sigma" is widely used in memes and jokes, often by younger students.
High-value man (HVM)	Shorthand for a man with money, status and physique, often paired with claims that women's "value" falls with age. Watch for it being used to rank peers.
Top G	A status nickname that began as one prominent influencer's self-branding. Now used by students as a joke or a label for someone seen as dominant.
Looksmaxxing	Trying to maximise physical attractiveness. It ranges from ordinary grooming and fitness to risky practices, extreme dieting and unregulated products.
Mogging	Outshining or dominating someone, usually in looks or status ("he got mogged"). Used to rank and humiliate.
Mewing	A tongue-posture technique promoted with claims that it reshapes the jaw; those claims are not supported by robust evidence. Younger students also use the "mewing" gesture as a meme to avoid answering a question.

Term	What it usually means
Tradwife	An online aesthetic built around highly traditional wife and mother roles. Not in itself manosphere content, but it can overlap with rigid gender ideology.

Not Knowing a Term Is Normal

The skill is not knowing every word. It is asking "**What does that mean to you?**" rather than pretending to know. Students often use the same word in very different ways, from an ironic joke to a sincere belief. Their answer tells you which.



How It Can Present at Different Ages

The same ecosystem can look very different across childhood and adolescence. These are examples for professional curiosity, **not a checklist for labelling a student.**

Ages 4 to 9

Copied phrases and rules

- **Play and exclusion:**
"Girls can't be the leader." "That's a boy job."
- **Emotion rules:** "Boys don't cry"; mocking a boy for seeking comfort
- **Spillover:** meme words from older siblings, gaming or YouTube, often not understood
- **Status and bodies:**
"the strongest boy is the best"
- **Put-downs:** "girl" used as an insult
- **Imitation:** repeating a line from a video because it gets a reaction

Ages 10 to 13

Memes, jokes, rating peers

- **Hierarchies:** ranking boys as alpha, beta or sigma to humiliate peers
- **"Only a joke":** sexist clips and catchphrases shared ironically for laughs
- **Rating girls:** scoring looks or "value"
- **Looksmaxxing:** jawline, height and muscle anxiety; "mogging"
- **Grievance:** from "girls get away with more" to "feminism is the problem"
- **Group chats:** language in voice chat or messages spills into school

Ages 14 to 18

A more coherent worldview

- **Red-pill explanations:**
"sexual marketplace", "high-value"
- **Black-pill fatalism:** "no point trying"; resentment presented as justified
- **Relationship control:** jealousy, surveillance, manipulation as strategy
- **Entitlement:** attention or sex treated as owed; hostility after rejection
- **Optimisation:** worth tied to dominance, money, gym or diet extremes
- **Targeted harm:** pile-ons, rumours, image sharing and deepfakes

One idea can change shape as a child grows (dominance and gender hierarchy):

Ages 4 to 9

"Boys are stronger, so boys should lead."

A copied rule; playground hierarchy

→

Ages 10 to 13

"He's alpha. He gets girls. That boy is a beta."

Meme and peer-status hierarchy

→

Ages 14 to 18

"Men need to dominate relationships or women will lose respect for them."

An ideological relationship script

The task is not to wait for the final stage. Early, curious intervention can challenge the message while protecting belonging and connection.



Recognise and Engage

Recognise: What You Might Notice

- ✓ Alpha, sigma or red-pill vocabulary that moves from joking into rigid beliefs about gender
- ✓ Growing hostility, contempt or distrust towards girls and women, or towards boys who don't fit narrow norms
- ✓ Preoccupation with status, muscle, looksmaxxing, extreme dieting or risky body practices
- ✓ Relationship language about manipulation, ownership, "winning", humiliation or entitlement
- ✓ Misogynistic, conspiratorial or grievance content clustering across platforms
- ✓ Withdrawal from friends, meals, sleep or activities alongside the language

Change over time matters more than a single meme, phrase or follow. Use the 4 Ps: People, Places, Platforms, Patterns.

Engage: Curiosity Before Confrontation

Understand first; don't turn it into a contest. Curiosity does not mean letting harm pass: name the harm, then keep the conversation open. Use **TED** (Tell me, Explain, Describe) and avoid "why", which sounds like an accusation.

Open Questions

- "What does that mean to you?"
- "Tell me where you first heard that."
- "Describe what you like about that creator or idea."
- "How do you think that might land with someone else?"
- "What would make you question it?"
- "Who is making money or getting attention from this?"

Traps to Avoid

- Arguing about the influencer, their wealth or their lifestyle
- Demanding the student denounce someone

- Public shaming or ridicule
- Treating one phrase as proof of radicalisation
- Forgetting the students affected by what was said

Say It Differently: Model Rewrites

Instinctive response

A RESPOND response

"That's disgusting. He's a criminal and you should know better."

"That comment is derogatory to women and girls. I'm curious though: what is it about him that people like?"

"We don't say that here. Detention."

"That comment isn't OK in this room because of how it lands for the girls here. Can you stay back for two minutes? I want to understand where it's coming from." (4Ds: *Direct, then Delay. A sanction may still follow under the behaviour policy; it is just not the only response.*)

"You don't actually believe that, do you?"

"What makes that feel true to you? Tell me where you first came across it."

"Boys will be boys. Just ignore it."

Never ignore it. "I heard that. It's not OK here, and I'll come and check in with you in a minute." Then check in with anyone affected.

"I'm calling your parents about this."

"I'm going to need to share this, and I'll tell you what happens next." Parents may well be involved, as part of a plan rather than a threat.

"Why would I listen to you? He's a millionaire and you're a teacher."

Don't defend your status or argue about his money. "Lots of people find that lifestyle impressive. What does being successful mean to you?" You are not trying to win the argument.

What good looks like: a calm tone; names the behaviour, not the child; one open question; a clear next step; remembers the students affected.

Supporting Those Affected

Much of this guide is about understanding the student who repeats the ideas. The people on the receiving end need as much attention: the girls and young women targeted, other students affected, and staff. The challenge in the moment is the start of the response, not the end of it.

After the Moment: Students Who Were Targeted

- **Ask for their view.** Speak privately and ask what happened, how it has affected them and what would help. Their wishes shape the response, but you cannot promise what will happen or keep it secret.
- **Check whether it is continuing:** in group chats, online, in the peer group or, for boarders, in the house. Tell the DSL what you know; don't investigate or ask to see images.
- **Think about retaliation.** A challenge in class can lead to a backlash later, online or at break. Plan with them for lessons, break times, travel and, for boarders, evenings.
- **Agree support and a named adult they trust.** Check back within a few days and again later, and tell them what has been done, as far as you can.
- **Don't move the burden onto them.** Where arrangements need to change, the student who was targeted should not be the one who has to change their routine.

Not Their Job

- Girls who are targeted are **not responsible for educating boys** about misogyny.
- Restorative conversations happen only if the affected student freely chooses them, and **never as a condition of resolving the incident.** They are not appropriate where there has been sexual harm or a significant imbalance of power; the DSL decides.

When Staff Are Targeted

- **Finding a conversation hard is different from being on the receiving end.** Hearing misogyny can leave any member of staff angry or upset: talk it through with a colleague, in supervision or with the DSL.
- **Being personally targeted by misogynistic abuse**, in person or online, is an incident, not something to absorb. Report it to your line manager and record it. It needs a management response and support for you: the school's Employee Assistance Programme if it has one, or **Education Support** (free, confidential, 24/7 on 08000 562 561). A debrief alone is not enough.
- **Female staff should not be expected to absorb misogynistic behaviour, or to resolve it on their own, because of their gender.** Leaders share the responsibility.
- If a student's behaviour towards staff also raises a safeguarding concern about the student, tell the DSL. **Staff Guide 101** has a full section: *When the Target Is a Member of Staff*.

The NOISE Check: a Critical-Literacy Tool

A quick way to take a post apart with a student, without attacking the student. Model it aloud; students aged 11 and above can do it themselves. Student versions, with a word decoder, are in the Student Guide 101 - 11 to 14 and Student Guide 101 - 14 to 18.

N

Negative

Which feelings does it use?
Anger, shame, jealousy, "not good enough"

O

Oppositional

Who is set against whom?
Us vs them, men vs women

I

Insecurity

Which worries does it profit from? Looks, money, dating, status

S

Simplistic

What is the too-easy answer?
One fix, whole groups stereotyped

E

Earnings

Who makes money from the click, follow, course or product?



@PeakMale.Protocol

Fictional account · 1.2M views

Bro. 90% of guys are invisible to women. Why? Weak jaw. Weak mindset. No money.

Women only want the top 10%. Stop being the "nice guy". Start being HIGH VALUE.

My 30-Day Alpha Protocol fixes your face, your bank account and your dating life.

Link in bio. Only 50 places left.

A fictional post written for these scenarios; the account does not exist. The "90%" figure is invented, which is part of the point.

Suggested Answers

- **N:** "invisible", "weak jaw, weak mindset": shame and fear of rejection
- **O:** women framed as judges who "only want the top 10%"; "nice guys" framed as losers. Sets boys against girls and against each other
- **I:** jaw, money and dating: three of the biggest teenage worries in one post
- **S:** an invented statistic and one product that "fixes" face, finances and relationships
- **E:** a paid programme, link in bio, false scarcity ("only 50 places left") and the view count as social proof

In class, use a teacher-written post like this one. Never use real posts by real students, and avoid screen-sharing live creator content.

Where Would You Draw the Line?

Eight fictional scenarios with suggested placements. They are for discussion, not a marking scheme.

Three Decisions, Every Time

1. **What do I do now?** Almost every scenario needs an in-the-moment response: challenge the behaviour, if it is safe to do so, and check on anyone affected.
2. **Where is it recorded?** Record every incident, including a first one, on the school's usual system: behaviour and discriminatory incidents on the behaviour record; anything that is a safeguarding concern on the safeguarding system, through the DSL. Information from parents, or screenshots of group chats, goes to the DSL; don't forward images.
3. **Does it need the DSL, and how fast?** A single incident may need a challenge and a record without an urgent referral. A threat, a sexual image or a risk to a child goes to the DSL immediately, even if it is the first incident.

The placements below show the **level of escalation**. They build on each other: B, C and D all include responding in the moment and recording.

A. Respond and record

B. Also share, to watch the pattern

C. DSL today

D. Immediate risk: DSL now

Scenario	Suggested placement	Reasoning
A Year 3 boy tells a classmate "girls can't be goalkeeper, boys are stronger".	A. Respond and record	Challenge kindly and teach ("anyone can be goalkeeper"); ask where he heard it. Record it, so that a pattern can be seen if it happens again.
A Year 7 student calls a quieter boy "a beta" in class. The class laughs.	A. Respond and record B. Also share, to watch the pattern	Stop it, support the boy targeted, address the laughter, and record it. Share it with the tutor or pastoral lead: repeated targeting is bullying.
A Year 8 group chat rates girls in the year out of 10. A parent forwards a screenshot.	C. DSL today	Potentially sexual harassment and child-on-child abuse: the DSL assesses whether the ratings are sexualised or degrading, whether girls are being repeatedly targeted, and the impact on them. Support the girls affected

Scenario	Suggested placement	Reasoning
		either way. Where it is sexual harassment, KCSIE is clear: never dismiss it as banter.
A Year 11 student says women "should obey men". Third time this month; he is withdrawing from friends.	C. DSL today	The pattern plus behaviour change plus withdrawal is the concern, not one phrase. The DSL decides next steps, including whether any Prevent consultation is appropriate.
A Year 12 student says girls who reject him "deserve what's coming". Filtering flags searches for incel forums.	D. Immediate risk: DSL now	A possible threat combined with a filtering alert. Don't wait until the end of the day. The DSL decides on police or Prevent involvement.
A Year 10 student is skipping meals and buying supplements to "fix" his jaw after looksmaxxing videos.	C. DSL today	A wellbeing and health concern. The DSL will involve the school nurse or health centre and counselling as appropriate.
A Year 13 student tracks his girlfriend's location and tells her who she can talk to.	C. DSL today	Recognised signs of controlling behaviour. DSL now if there are threats or fear for her safety. Support her as well as addressing him.
A Year 9 student shares an AI-generated sexualised image of a classmate.	D. Immediate risk: DSL now	Follow the UKCIS nudes and semi-nudes guidance: don't view, copy, forward or delete the image; secure the device if needed. AI-generated or digitally altered sexual images of children may constitute indecent images under UK law. Don't try to establish their legal status yourself: tell the DSL immediately. The DSL assesses the safeguarding risks and seeks police advice where appropriate. The guidance allows an authorised DSL to view an image only in exceptional circumstances where it is necessary for safeguarding.

If You Are Unsure Between Two Columns

Choose the more protective one and speak to the DSL: **if in doubt, N before O**. Use the **Three Lenses** to justify your decision (Risk, Rights, Resources) and the **4 Ps** to see what is involved. Anyone can refer directly to children's social care if they believe a child is at risk; telling the DSL does not remove your own responsibility.

Keep the Boys in View

- **Controlling behaviour is often a group activity.** Research on teenage relationship abuse finds it can be "a 'collective' endeavour", with young men's friends encouraging them to control their partners. Work with the peer group's norms, not only the individual.
- **Watch for distancing language.** In one study, professionals discussing "toxic masculinity" in a school peer group described the boys as "unpleasant", and planned interventions "remained removed from the real, live boys". It is hard to help someone you have written off.
- **Hold accountability and respect together:** challenge the behaviour, and keep treating the boy as someone worth engaging.
- **Look after staff too.** Hearing misogyny from students can leave staff angry or upset. Make space to talk it through (the 2-minute debrief, supervision or the DSL) before planning the response. Being personally targeted is different: see *Supporting Those Affected*.

Firmin et al., *Beyond Risk in Adolescent Safeguarding* (2026), pp. 38 and 88.

Walk It Through RESPOND: Three Age-Group Scenarios

Fictional scenarios with model answers. In every one, someone other than the speaker is affected: RESPOND is not only about the student repeating the ideas.

Ages 4 to 9: "Men are in charge"

In free play, a Year 4 boy keeps telling girls they can't be "the boss" of the game because "men are in charge; my brother's videos say so." Two girls now refuse to join in.

Step	What you do
● Recognise	4 Ps: a copied script; peer impact (two girls now excluded); a home and online source (the brother's videos).

Step	What you do
● Engage	TED: "Tell me what 'the boss' means." "Explain who says that." Direct, kindly: "In our games anyone can be the boss."
● Support	Safety first: bring the girls back into the game and reset its rule. Connection before correction for the boy.
● Pause	90-second grounding. Three Lenses: likely low risk; note the older sibling's online content; everyone's right to join in.
● Offer	Model alternatives: stories and play roles that show a range of leaders; take turns being "the boss".
● Notify	Tell the class teacher and record as soon as is practicably possible. The DSL decides whether to talk with parents about home device use.
● Document	GOLD: the child's exact words, who was affected, what you did and why.

Ages 10 to 13: "Mog" ratings in a group chat

A Year 8 boy posts classmates' photos in a group chat with "mog" ratings. A boy rated lowest has started skipping lunch and avoiding the changing rooms.

Step	What you do
● Recognise	Appearance-based bullying and potential child-on-child abuse. Assess whether the images or comments are sexualised, whether there is repeated targeting, and the impact on the students involved. The boy avoiding lunch and the changing rooms needs prompt safeguarding attention.
● Engage	Speak to the student who posted calmly and privately. TED, not "why". 4Ds: Direct if you see it happen.
● Support	Safety first: check in today with the boy rated lowest (lunch, changing rooms) and with any other students pictured.
● Pause	Three Lenses: is the chat still active? Images of others shared without consent. Do not investigate or promise confidentiality.
● Offer	Model alternatives: repair and restorative options, but only after the DSL's safeguarding decisions. If in doubt, N before O.
● Notify	DSL as soon as is practicably possible, and today. The DSL coordinates any contact with parents or external agencies.

Step	What you do
------	-------------

- | | |
|---------------|--|
| ●
Document | GOLD. Record what you saw, where, and who told you. Don't forward or share the photos. If any image is sexual, follow the UKCIS nudes and semi-nudes guidance instead: don't view, copy, forward or delete it, and tell the DSL immediately. |
|---------------|--|

Ages 14 to 18 and Boarding: "No point trying"

A Year 12 boarder tells a houseparent that girls "only want the top 10%" and there's "no point trying". He has stopped going to meals and games late into the night.

Step	What you do
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- | | |
|----------------|--|
| ●
Recognise | Black-pill fatalism alongside withdrawal, missed meals and disrupted sleep. The wellbeing concern comes first. |
| ● Engage | The houseparent keeps the relationship and asks directly and kindly how he is doing. Don't debate the ideology tonight. |
| ● Support | Safety first: meals, a night-time routine, a trusted adult. Your calm is contagious. |
| ● Pause | 90-second grounding. Three Lenses: consider any risk to himself; his right to support; what boarding, counselling and the school nurse or health centre can offer. |
| ● Offer | Model alternatives: counselling and pastoral support; offline interests; other pictures of what success and relationships look like. |
| ● Notify | DSL as soon as is practicably possible. If there is any sign of risk to himself, act immediately under the mental health and safeguarding procedures: go straight from R to N. |
| ●
Document | GOLD: his exact words, dates, and the pattern observed by boarding staff. |

RESPOND is taught in sequence but works as a helix: you may go straight from Recognise to Notify when there is risk, or loop back to Recognise when new information appears. With this content, the steps most often skipped are **Pause** (reacting to the ideology rather than assessing risk) and **Document** (single comments go unrecorded, so the pattern stays invisible). *Staff Guide 101* has an interactive RESPOND Helix showing how the steps move in practice.

Five Things to Remember

1. **An ecosystem, not a website:** many creators, one set of recurring messages.
2. **Driven by influencers and algorithms:** content finds students through recommendation and monetised attention.

3. **It arrives through humour, gaming, fitness and self-improvement**, not only through obviously ideological content.
4. **One phrase is not a diagnosis**: look at People, Places, Platforms and Patterns.
5. **Connection beats ridicule or panic**: connection, critical literacy and clear boundaries are stronger together.

Sources

- Firmin, Langhoff, Peace, Lefevre, Huegler and Eyal-Lubling (2026), *Beyond Risk in Adolescent Safeguarding*, Policy Press (open access)
- Dublin City University Anti-Bullying Centre, *Recommending Toxicity* (summary report, 2024)
- Haslop, Ringrose, Cambazoglu and Milne (2024), *Social Media + Society* (University of Liverpool and UCL)
- Department for Education, *Keeping Children Safe in Education 2026*
- UKCIS, *Sharing nudes and semi-nudes: advice for education settings*

Figures checked against the original sources in September 2026. The glossary, age examples and scenarios are practice guidance, not research findings.

RESPOND Safeguarding Framework Reference Scenarios · Staff Guide 102

Scenario 102: Online Influence and the Manosphere (companion to Scenario 101)

© 2026/27 | **RESPOND** Safeguarding Framework

Aligned with: KCSIE 2026 | Working Together to Safeguard Children 2026 | *Freedom from violence and abuse* (December 2025) | RSHE statutory guidance (published July 2025; statutory from September 2026) | Equality Act 2010

Last Updated: September 2026 | Next Review: September 2027, or on publication of KCSIE 2027 if sooner

For staff in schools and other settings working with children. You may share it with colleagues. Share the student and parent guides, not this page, with students and families.